

Cosmic Shore

Steam Early Access

Remaining scope, owners, and effort to launch. All features and engineering are complete. What is left is dialogue content, finalising, testing, and launch execution.

Prepared 28 July 2026	Company Froglet Inc.	Launch type Paid Early Access, no IAP	Platform Windows x64 via SteamPipe	Team 8 contributors
100.5 PERSON-DAYS LEFT Across six workstreams and eight named owners.	6 weeks CALENDAR PATH Heavily parallelised. Includes one Steam review bounce.	9/10 PUNCH-LIST PROJECTS SHIPPED The tenth, monetisation, is deliberately cut from launch.	0 FEATURES LEFT TO BUILD Features and engineering are complete. What remains is content, validation, and marketing.	

Where the project stands

The May 2026 punch list scoped a paid full release with an in-build monetisation rail. We have re-scoped to **Early Access**: a paid app sold on the strength of what already works, with no in-app purchases at launch. That single decision removed the two largest unfinished engineering projects from the critical path and converted the remaining plan from roughly ten projects into **six short workstreams**.

All three core minigames, Tournament mode, the freestyle hub, the netcode and session layer, vessel progression, and the telemetry stack are **shipped and playable**. The settings panel, which the prior plan still carried as open engineering, was **completed and verified in the repository** during preparation of this checkpoint. The residual 100.5 person-days is quest dialogue and data, business setup, build and delivery pipeline, validation passes, a stability gate, and the marketing assets a converting store page requires.

The honest read on risk

Three items carry genuine schedule risk and none of them is a coding problem. The Steamworks partner account has external processing time we do not control, so it starts in week one. The capsule art and trailer are 13 person-days on a single contributor inside a two-week window. And Shombith now carries a third of all remaining work, which leaves the plan with no slack on its busiest owner. All three are detailed in the risk register on page 6, each with the specific item that can move to relieve it.

Decisions this plan locks

DECISION	POSITION
Launch type	Early Access, not a demo and not a 1.0. Honest framing as a party game growing new vessels and episodes.
Monetisation	App price only. Episode tokens and web checkout are cut. The checkout flow has an unresolved server-side entitlement gap and must not take money until a backend verifies orders. Crystal-earned vessel unlocks remain as the progression loop.
Netcode	Unity Gaming Services Relay plus Netcode for GameObjects. Shipped and locked. No Steamworks networking, no host migration for Early Access.
Steam SDK	None at launch. Overlay, wishlists, reviews, and forums all work without it. Achievements and Steam Input become a first content patch.
Crash reporting	Unity Cloud Diagnostics. Zero new vendors, and the consent toggle already exists in the shipped settings panel.
Hardware floor	GTX 1060-class, 8 GB RAM, Windows 10 64-bit. Confirmed by one profiling session in week three, then locked.

The following represents the bulk of the original punch list. It is complete, in the repository, and playable. It is listed so the remaining 100.5 person-days reads in proportion.

PROJECT	STATUS	WHAT SHIPPED
Minigame trio	SHIPPED	Hex Race, Crystal Capture, and Joust across four intensities and one to four players, with domain-aggregated scoring and AI backfill to twelve players. Four bonus modes beyond the original slice: Astro League, Brood Rush, Rampage, Skim Race.
Tournament mode	SHIPPED	Live as "Maelstrom". Chains Hex Race into Joust into Crystal Capture, with race-to-six placement scoring, standings, and crystal-wallet credit.
Freestyle hub and Painting Mode	SHIPPED	Full toy system: vessel changer, domain changer, a sixteen-painting connect-the-dots gallery with WebGL share export, and the Wanderway conveyor. All vessels flyable.
Netcode and sessions	SHIPPED	Delivered on a stronger stack than planned. The punch list assumed Mirror plus a Steam transport; we shipped UGS Relay with eager per-user sessions, presence lobby, party invites, friends, kick, and disconnect handling. Works on Steam with no Steam transport required.
Time-to-Tournament	BY DESIGN	Tournament is always unlocked and reachable from first boot. The quest chain is the guided progression. One validation pass remains in Workstream C.
Vessel progression economy	SHIPPED	Hangar grid plus unlock system. Vessels unlock by spending earned crystals. One tuning pass remains in Workstream C.
Telemetry	SHIPPED	PostHog sink, locked event schema, match envelope, onboarding and game funnels, consent-gated throughout.
Settings system	COMPLETE	Four-tab PC settings panel covering display, resolution, v-sync, frame cap, quality, colourblind mode, subtitles, consent, invert axes, and audio. The Unity prefab wiring, still open on the prior plan, is verified complete and live in the main menu and pause panel.
Performance program	ONGOING	Burst spatial index, instanced prisms, adaptive animation, diagnostics overlay, benchmark tool with sweep. Remaining work is to lock the floor and gate it, in Workstream D.
Legal groundwork	DRAFTED	Privacy policy template and consent setup written. Hosting and store-page linkage remain in Workstream F.

Cut from Early Access, retained on the roadmap

Each item below was scoped, assessed, and deliberately deferred. Anything on this list appearing in a launch conversation is scope creep.

CUT	WHY IT IS SAFE TO DEFER
All IAP and web checkout	Early Access sells the app itself. The checkout flow has an unresolved entitlement-verification gap and must not take money until a backend verifies orders.
Steamworks SDK integration	Not required to ship. Cloud Save already roams progress and the Input System already handles pads. Achievements become a good first-patch beat.
Full rebinding UI	Invert-Y and invert-throttle shipped. Steam Input covers controller remapping with no work from us.
Host migration and rejoin-in-progress	Disconnect handling exists. Migration was a multi-week task with Early-Access-acceptable absence.
Localisation	English-only Early Access. New strings continue to go into tables as they already do.
Open playtest and Next Fest	Next Fest is reserved for the 1.0 beat, where the wishlist push matters most.
Missions, Arena games, mobile, cosmetics	Already out of scope in the prior plan. Restated so the fence moves with the project.

Remaining work, part one

Workstreams A and B · 15.0 person-days

A · Steam business setup 1 calendar week, mostly waiting · Shombith leading setup, Caleb and Garrett on administration and legal

#	TASK	OWNER	DAYS	RUNNING
A1	Steamworks partner account, identity, tax and banking. Carries external processing lead time, so it starts first.	Shombith	1.0	1.0
A2	Pay Steam Direct fee and create the app record	Shombith	0.5	1.5
A3	Content survey and mature-content questionnaire	Garrett	0.5	2.0
A4	Early Access questionnaire: why Early Access, expected duration, planned full-version differences, current state, pricing intent, community role	Caleb	1.0	3.0
A5	Coming Soon page live. Steam requires it visible at least two weeks before release and every live week earns wishlists.	Caleb	1.0	4.0
A6	Set launch price and launch discount	Garrett	0.5	4.5
A7	Submit build and store page for Steam review	Shombith	1.0	5.5
Workstream A subtotal			5.5	5.5

B · Windows build and delivery pipeline 2 weeks, parallel with A · Shombith

#	TASK	OWNER	DAYS	RUNNING
B1	Windows x64 build profile authored and committed. Windows builds already run on a dedicated UGS automated build server; this is a verification pass plus committing the profile so the configuration is reproducible from source.	Shombith	1.0	6.5
B2	PC platform sanity pass: Wwise audio init, keyboard and mouse plus Xbox and PlayStation pads, alt-tab and focus handling, quit path from the menu, no mobile-only prompts or share dead-ends	Shombith	3.0	9.5
B3	Offline and service-outage behaviour: launching with no network reaches the menu with a clear message rather than hanging on authentication	Shombith	1.0	10.5
B4	SteamPipe upload script and branch convention: default for live, beta for playtest, internal for the team	Shombith	1.5	12.0
B5	Automated depot build from a tagged commit on the existing UGS build server, with the steps documented	Shombith	1.5	13.5
B6	Enable Cloud Diagnostics crash reporting behind the existing consent toggle	Shombith	1.0	14.5
B7	Verify the Steam overlay renders over the game on a real Steam playtest build	Shombith	0.5	15.0
Workstream B subtotal			9.5	15.0

C · In-game finalising, quests, instrumentation and validation 3 to 4 weeks · Shombith and Ian on engineering and dashboards, Caleb and Garrett on quest dialogue, Charles on audio, Andrew on testing

All features and engineering in this workstream are complete, on a separate branch. What remains is dialogue content, the progression data update, finalising, and end-to-end testing.

#	TASK	OWNER	DAYS	RUNNING
C1	Settings panel prefab wiring COMPLETE All four tabs verified wired and live in the main menu and pause panel.	Shombith	0	15.0
C2	First-session validation: fresh install, guest sign-in, menu, first Tournament. Confirm the quest chain and controls overlay carry a new player unaided. Observe three to five first-timers and fix only what actually stops them.	Andrew, Shombith	3.0	18.0
C3	Verify the funnel dashboard answers median time-to-Tournament from real sessions	Ian	2.0	20.0
C4	De-scope sweep of visible UI. Episode purchase surfaces, store screen, and locked screens receive deliberate coming-soon treatment rather than appearing broken.	Shombith	3.0	23.0
C5	Confirm vessel-unlock economy for launch: crystal earn rates against vessel prices, one tuning pass in config	Shombith	1.0	24.0
C6	Audio coverage pass: menu bed, freestyle bed, per-minigame beds, UI stings. Fill the gaps that would read as silence in a trailer.	Charles	4.0	28.0
C7	Instrumentation and analytics buildout: event coverage against the locked schema, dashboard construction, end-to-end validation of the pipeline	Shombith, Ian	5.0	33.0
C8	Daily thirty-minute all-modes play session with logged findings, running for the duration of the program	Andrew	3.0	36.0
C9	Quest and progression dialogue. Author the dialogue that carries the quest chain and load it into the existing dialogue runtime. The system is built; this is the content that runs through it.	Caleb, Garrett, Shombith	6.0	42.0
C10	Quest and progression data update in UGS. Update the quest and progression data in Cloud Save so unlock state, quest claims, and progression persist and roam correctly. A data and configuration pass on a shipped system. One calendar week.	Shombith	5.0	47.0
C11	Test and finalise the quest and progression system end to end: a fresh account through the full chain, claim and unlock behaviour, and cloud persistence across devices. Andrew leads testing; the rest of the group finalises against what it finds.	Andrew, Shombith, Caleb, Garrett	4.0	51.0
Workstream C subtotal			36.0	51.0

D · Stability gate and load time 2 to 3 weeks · Garrett leading, with Shombith, Yash and Andrew

Quality bar carried forward unchanged: zero P0 or P1 defects at submission, and no more than ten P2 defects with documented workarounds.

#	TASK	OWNER	DAYS	RUNNING
D1	Profiling session on the floor machine: four-player Tournament at intensity four. Lock the hardware floor and the frame and memory targets.	Yash	3.0	54.0
D2	Load time, every game mode at every intensity. Measure cold boot to menu and menu to first playable frame across the full mode and intensity matrix, then reduce it. Bootstrap sequence, scene load, and asset warm-up are the candidates. One calendar week, with a published load-time target set alongside the frame and memory targets.	Shombith, Yash, Andrew	8.0	62.0
D3	Two-hour soak across freestyle and back-to-back tournaments: memory growth, GC spikes, prism-count ceiling behaviour	Yash	2.0	64.0
D4	Multiplayer regression: the existing party and presence suites, plus four-player thirty-minute disconnect and rejoin scenarios	Andrew	4.0	68.0
D5	Bug bash week two weeks out from submission, triaged to the P0 through P3 rubric	Yash, Andrew, Garrett	5.0	73.0
D6	Signed exit checklist before submission	Garrett	1.0	74.0
Workstream D subtotal			23.0	74.0

E · Marketing minimum 1 to 2 weeks · Caleb and Will, with Shombith or Yash for in-game integration

#	TASK	OWNER	DAYS	RUNNING
E1	Positioning one-pager: "Party Game for Pilots", three pillars, Early Access framing	Caleb	1.0	75.0
E2	Steam copy pack: short and long description, feature bullets honest about Early Access state, tags, and the Q and A text from A4	Caleb	3.0	78.0
E3	Capsule and key art set across all five required sizes. Largest single art item and a gate on A5.	Will	6.0	84.0
E4	Five or more screenshots at 1920 by 1080: one per minigame plus Tournament and freestyle	Will	1.0	85.0
E5	Trailer version one, sixty seconds or less, plus a thirty-second social cut, captured from the real build and gameplay-first	Will	6.0	91.0
E6	Discord live with the invite on the Steam page, plus a basic landing page	Caleb	1.0	92.0
E7	One closed playtest of ten to twenty-five people via the Steam beta branch. Validates the upload pipeline, the overlay, and first-session flow in a single beat, and produces quotes and clips for the page.	Caleb, Shombith / Yash	4.0	96.0
E8	Launch-day communications drafted and scheduled: announcement, Discord, social, press	Caleb	1.0	97.0
E9	Wishlist baseline and weekly tracking from the day the Coming Soon page goes live	Caleb	0.5	97.5
Workstream E subtotal			23.5	97.5

F · Legal and compliance 1 week · Shombith and Caleb

#	TASK	OWNER	DAYS	RUNNING
F1	Host the privacy policy at a public URL and link it in-game and on the store page. Template already written; the in-game settings row already exists.	Shombith	1.0	98.5
F2	Support contact, email or Discord, live on the store page	Caleb	0.5	99.0
F3	EULA decision. Steam's default Subscriber Agreement suffices unless custom terms are needed.	Caleb	0.5	99.5
F4	Confirm the analytics and crash consent flow satisfies GDPR and COPPA posture for a PC-only Early Access launch. Consent gating is already implemented, so this is a review rather than a build.	Shombith	1.0	100.5
Workstream F subtotal			3.0	100.5

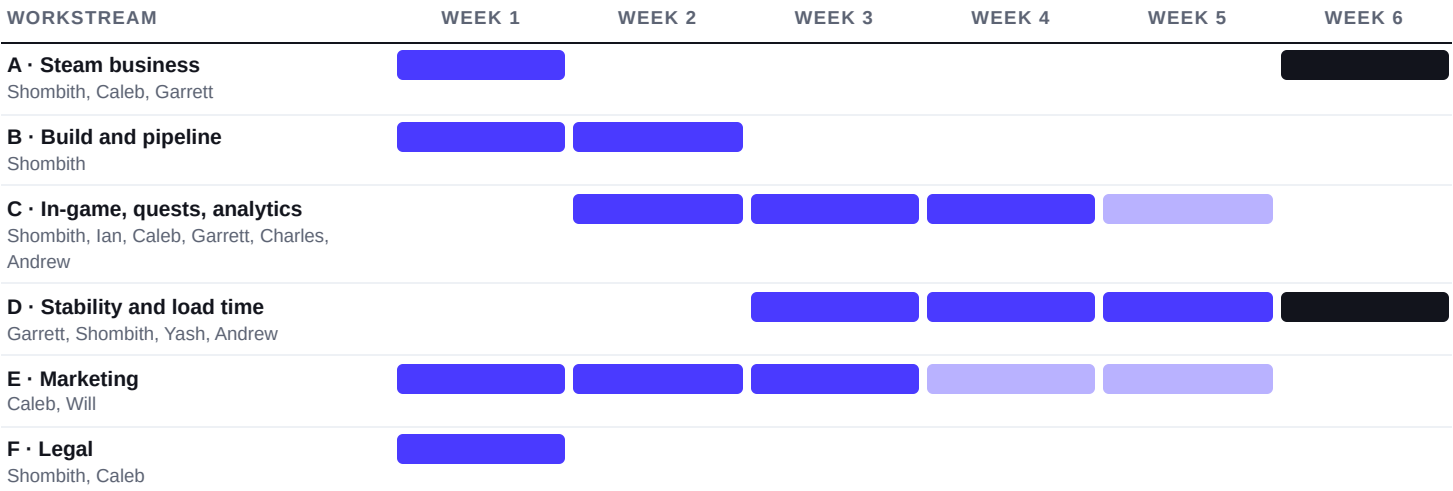
Load by contributor

CONTRIBUTOR	FOCUS	DAYS
Shombith	Setup lead, build pipeline, quests, load time	33.5
Andrew	Testing, quest validation, regression	15.0
Caleb	Store copy, marketing, quest dialogue, legal	15.0
Will	Capsule art, screenshots, trailer	13.0
Yash	Performance, load time, stability	9.5
Garrett	Stability lead, quest dialogue, sign-off	6.0
Ian	Analytics and dashboards	4.5
Charles	Audio	4.0
Total		100.5

Risk register

LEVEL	RISK AND MITIGATION
HIGH	Art capacity. Capsules and trailer are 13 days on one contributor inside a two-week window. Mitigation: both start in week one, and the trailer cut can be split to a second resource if week three slips.
HIGH	Steamworks processing. Identity, tax, and banking verification is outside our control. The one-week estimate assumes a clean first pass. Mitigation: A1 starts day one, ahead of every dependent item.
HIGH	Owner capacity. Shombith now carries 33.5 of 100.5 days, a third of all remaining work, across five of six workstreams. Against roughly thirty working days in a six-week window that is full commitment with no slack, so any slip lands directly on the date. Mitigation: the quest data update (C10) and the legal review (F1, F4) are the most portable items and can move to Ian or Caleb.
MEDIUM	Review bounce. Each Steam review pass runs one to five business days. Mitigation: week six is held as buffer for exactly one rejection loop.
LOW	Branch integration. Workstream C is progressing on a separate branch; merge cost is not included in the estimates above.

The plan is heavily parallelised. Four workstreams start in week one so that the two items with external lead time, the Steamworks account and the capsule art, are never the reason a later item waits. The Coming Soon page goes live in week two to open wishlist accumulation as early as Steam allows.



Solid bars are primary execution. Lighter bars are trailing marketing work. Black bars are gates: the exit sign-off and the submission to Steam review.

WEEK	MILESTONE
Week 1	Steamworks account, fee, and surveys submitted. Windows build profile committed and PC sanity pass begins. Privacy policy hosted and legal decisions closed. Capsule art and positioning copy start.
Week 2	Coming Soon page live , opening wishlist accumulation. SteamPipe pipeline, automated depot build, and crash reporting land. In-game validation, quest dialogue authoring, and the analytics buildout begin.
Week 3	Build pipeline complete and overlay verified. De-scope sweep, economy tuning, audio pass, and the quest and progression data update in UGS all in progress. Capsule art delivered to the store page. Performance floor confirmed on the 1060-class machine, and the load-time week runs across every mode and intensity.
Week 4	Closed playtest on the Steam beta branch , validating upload, overlay, and first-session flow together. Multiplayer regression and soak testing run. Trailer and final screenshots onto the page.
Week 5	Bug bash and triage to the P0 through P3 rubric. Quest and progression system tested end to end and finalised. De-scope sweep closed. Launch-day communications drafted and scheduled.
Week 6	Exit checklist signed, then submit for Steam review . Launch on approval, with the remainder of the week held as buffer for one review bounce.

Definition of done

All six simultaneously true.

1. Steam page live for at least two weeks with final assets, and the build has passed review.
2. A fresh install on the floor machine reaches a completed four-player Tournament, humans and bots, with zero P0 or P1 defects.
3. A fresh account completes the quest chain, with unlocks and progression persisting through Cloud Save.
4. Cold boot to playable meets the load-time target in every game mode at every intensity.
5. Crash reporting and funnel telemetry visible in dashboards from playtest builds.
6. One closed playtest run through the actual Steam beta branch.
7. Privacy policy and support contact live.
8. Garrett has signed the exit checklist.

What this checkpoint asks for

- **No additional engineering headcount.** The remaining work is covered by the eight named contributors.
- **Art is the constraint, not code.** If one investment accelerates the date, it is a second pair of hands on the trailer cut in weeks two and three.
- **Scope discipline holds.** The cut list on page 2 is the fence. Monetisation returns after launch, once a backend verifies entitlements.
- **Wishlists start compounding in week two.** Every week the Coming Soon page is live is measurable pipeline into launch day.

Summary

Cosmic Shore is feature-complete for Early Access. Nine of the ten original punch-list projects have shipped, the tenth was deliberately cut, and the settings work the prior plan still carried as open is verified complete. What remains is 100.5 person-days across eight people. No features are left to build: every system, including the quest and progression layer, is engineered and in the branch. The residual work is dialogue content, finalising, testing, and launch execution. The binding constraint is therefore not the work itself but Shombith's capacity, now fully committed against a six-week window. Redistributing the quest data update or the legal review buys back the slack.